

Vertigo

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No 822 October 2018



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB

Wellington Section Monthly Bulletin

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REEL ROCK 13
Now on sale

[Annual Section Reports here](#)

James Hobson makes his way across a steep traverse on the Bealey side of Rome Ridge at about 1,850m. [More here](#)

Chair's Report

October 2018

Nearly the end of another dull, uneventful year. Not really. The glaciers have continued to shrink; the government says it will finally introduce a travel tax from the 1st of January 2019 (but what will they do with it?); as president of the NZAC, John Palmer has overseen the biggest single change in the club's structure since it was formed; and quite a few other things to boot, not least of which were our hugely popular summer rock and winter snow craft courses.

But before I delve into the year's highlights, I really want to thank all our volunteers, our summer and winter instructors and especially the Wellington Section Committee, without which you wouldn't be reading this, nor would you get to see the Banff mountain film festival, Reel Rock, go on section trips, or attend courses and section nights. The unsung heroes of the section are really the Committee, without which the section would not exist.

So what did the Wellington Section Committee bring you this year? Some FY 2017/18 reports are [here](#). In brief:

- * a continuous series of guest speakers,
- * seminars on avalanche awareness and outdoor photography,
- * a photo competition,
- * a place to meet and socialise with other climbers,
- * a quality online newsletter providing you with up-to-date trip reports, upcoming events and an opportunity to share your own experiences with the wider section,
- * section rock climbing trips and meets,
- * ski touring meets,
- * alpine trips and meets,
- * Facebook and Instagram accounts so you can see what others are doing and share your own epic tales of joy and fear,
- * courses, well you know about those (sign up early or miss out),
- * film nights (Banff, Reel Rock, TGR ski movies - OK, so TGR was a flop along with the venue - we are working on finding a better venue),
- * this has all been possible due to efficient management and accounting.

So, next time you sign up for a course, attend a section film screening, turn up for a section night, go on a section trip or meet or read an edition of Vertigo, you can thank the Section Committee for their time and effort in making whatever you are doing possible.

For my part (as section Chair) I couldn't do it without them. I also arrange the winter snowcraft courses, which I couldn't do without the help of the Committee and the Instructors. So it's appropriate that I also make note of how well run these courses are, thanks to the high level of skill and experience that our volunteer instructors bring, as well as the endlessly evolving system management framework that has been created to make these courses run smoothly. Each year we continue to improve our booking and registration templates and financial management policies and procedures. Feedback from students is consistently positive, particularly the 2:1 student instructor ratio. The focus on instruction, as opposed to the old 'lets go climbing and maybe you will learn something' approach, also sits well with the current health and safety culture. Not that there is any substitute for experience when learning to climb, of course.

We also seem to have finally found a section night venue that works for us -The Third Eye
- when the laptop works and we have the right cables.

So, while the section grows from strength to strength, we continue to rely on a group of dedicated volunteers. If you would like to join our select group of diversely skilled and motivated individuals, you should nominate yourself for election - that, of course, includes the position of Chair - it's always good to have new people with new ideas and different ways of doing things.

On that note, the following quote (from last month) is even more appropriate this month. "If you haven't got any skin in the game you aren't taking any risk - if you aren't taking any risk, you aren't making any difference or adding value". Simon Williamson 2018

Simon Williamson
Chair: NZAC Wellington

Any comments on what you like or don't like - send an email to wellington@alpineclub.org.nz or tweet us [@NZACWellington](https://twitter.com/NZACWellington).

Section News

November Section night

From 6pm Wed 28th November, Nina Sawicki will take us on a journey to Kanchenjunga base camp in Nepal.

All Section night talks are held at The Third Eye, Tuatara Brewery, level 2, 30 Arthur Street, from 6pm. Also a good place to collect or return hired climbing gear.

Section nights beyond November

No section nights December and January.

Wed 27th February 2019, climbing and pizzas at Hangdogs TBC

Wed 27th March, Paul Maxim will talk about peaks, places and prints - as a climber and writer, how he has been able to very successfully combined these two interests.

Wed 24th April, Derek Cheng will present some of his climbing in Yosemite TBC.

Wed 29th May, Paul Hersey will take us through some of his alpine journeys describing a mix of climbing and writing about climbing.

Wed 26th Jun, Penny Webster will take us through her recent climb of Mt Everest.

Nigel Roberts' all-time favourite 50-state shot is this one that Aidan Brennan took of him on Sunday, 6 July 1997, shortly before he reached the summit of Denali (6,194 m / 20,320 ft). Mt Foraker (5,304 m / 17,400 ft) is on the right. Denali is both the highest of the fifty US state highpoints and also rated the hardest to climb. Twenty years, two months, and four days after this picture was taken, he reached the summit of his fiftieth US state highpoint -- namely, New York's Mt Marcy (1,629 m / 5,344 ft). Come and hear all about Nigel's impressive two decade plus journey at our **Wednesday 31st October** Section night.



From the Editor

Crikey, Simon has so much to say this month that I had to notch him down to 12 point text and shift myself over here to the right. So much for 'man of few words'. But well said Simon.

An important item to note this month is that our Wellington Section ReelRock 13 is now on sale - more [here](#).

Trip reports! Since you've clearly been so active in the mountains this winter that you haven't even had time write any up, I'm more than happy to receive them for future Vertigos. Just type up a report of between half and three pages as a Word document, email it to occasionalclimber@gmail.com with up to six jpeg images if you have them and I'll format it for Vertigo.

Peter

Section News

Gear Hire

Don't forget the Section has gear for hire: avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, hammers, helmets, crampons, probes, PLBs, ice hammers (entry level).

To hire gear please fill in the form [here](#). Why not come to a last Wednesday of the month Section evening to collect or return gear.

Each item costs \$5 per week with the exception of PLBs – PLBs are free but require a deposit of \$50 refundable on return.

A little bit of advance notice would be appreciated as gear often needs to be retrieved from the gear store in Lower Hutt. Gear collections and drop-offs are usually available in the city during the working day or at section night.

Accommodation on Mt Ruapehu

Our snowcraft courses for the past few years have been run out of the Manawatu Tramping and Skiing Club lodge on Whakapapa. We're always made to feel welcome and the lodge is well situated a short walk from the top of the Bruce Road. Membership to the club is extremely reasonable - \$35 per year or \$50 for a family membership. Members stay at the lodge for \$36 a night including food. If you're looking for somewhere to base yourself for your winter pursuits or rock-climbing over the summer months go to www.mtsc.org.nz/joining.php to find out more about joining the club.

UIAA ice climbing season

The calendar for the 2019 UIAA ice climbing season is now in place. Read [more](#). Also the Global Rock and Ice Climbing Festivals: all in one place [here](#).

Notices

NZAC instruction courses

Click for more details [Ice Climbing](#) [Ski Touring](#) (and the new guide [here](#)) [High Alpine Skills](#)

Launch of Aoraki – Tai Poutini: a guide for mountaineers

Friday 9th November, 5:30 pm: Thistle Hall, Cuba Street, Wellington. MC Dave Bamford; speakers Lou Sanson and Graham Langton. More [here](#)

Scenic Playground: The story behind New Zealand's mountain tourism

A new book to be launched during November. Find out more [here](#)

MSC Alpine Tramping Video Series

A new series of 12 videos are being progressively released that help trampers prepare for alpine sections of popular NZ Tracks. More [here](#)

A Walk in the Park?

A deep dive into tramping incidents in New Zealand. Find out [more](#)

XII ISMM World Congress On Mountain Medicine

21-24 November 2018, Kathmandu, Nepal, www.ismm2018.org, email

Is your KiwiSaver account in a Socially Responsible Investment (SRI*) fund?

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Responsible investment is a process that takes into account environmental, social, governance (ESG) and ethical issues; including pollution, resource over-use and child labour

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Keith Munro KiwiSaver and Mortgage Adviser 027 654 6568 keithm@mtgelab.co.nz

*SRI may specifically exclude investments in:
• Alcohol production • Gambling operations • Tobacco production, distribution, supply & retailing • Military weapons manufacturing • Civilian firearms production, distribution, supply & retailing • Nuclear power production & uranium mining • Fossil fuels exploration, extraction, refinement, distribution, supply & retailing • Adult entertainment content production • Genetically modified organisms, excluding research & Development



Coming Trips, Courses, Events

All our planned South Island trips come with the added bonus that rental vehicle costs for Wellington Section members are covered by the Section.

If you're uncertain about the skill level required with any of the trips, would like to register your interest or to find out more, email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the Committee can help with advertising and logistics.

When	What and where
16 to 19 November	Wellington Section Climbing Meet - Paines Ford, Takaka Contact Eric Duggan for more information or to confirm your spot For members, your transport from the airport to Hangdog Camp ground is subsidised. This is a climbing meet, not an instruction course. You must be able to belay and lead in an outdoor environment and have your own safety and climbing equipment. It is not required to have rope or quickdraws but you need to buddy up with others that have them. Hangdog Camp grounds is the usual accomm situation but you can organise alternative accommodation.
Late November TBC	Nuns Veil Maximum 6 - 2 places still open, contact Simon Williamson for more information and to express interest. Section will cover rental car cost from Christchurch.
2 December	Outdoor Training NZ River Safety Course On the Hutt River TBC, taking in to account river flow, algae alerts, etc. \$50 / person. Access the registration form here
4 and 11 December Two screenings on consecutive Tuesdays, commencing 6pm	Reel Rock 13 >>> Nga Taonga Sound & Vision Cinema, 84 Taranaki St Tickets \$19 members, \$21 non members, \$14 Under 15s Get in quick, last year was a sellout. Cinema seats 107 only. Book your tickets: Tuesday 4 December here Tuesday 11 December here Please note - we're using Eventopia to process all bookings online. Eventopia applies a handling fee per ticket of about \$2
7 to 10 December	Wellington Section Climbing Meet - Castle Hill Contact Stacey Wong for more information or to confirm your spot.
13 - 27 April 2019	Wellington Section Trip to Arapiles Please email your expression of interest to Jenny Cossey Fly to Melbourne individually and leave by car in a group from Melbourne on Saturday 13th April. Returning by car to Melbourne on Saturday 27th April. Please note these are the two weeks of the NZ school holidays which includes Good Friday (19th April), Easter Monday (22nd April) and ANZAC Day (25th April). Please book your own air tickets early to suit you. The Wellington section will give a subsidy towards car hire for the trip for a maximum of ten section members who register with the trip organiser Jenny Cossey on a first come first served basis.



Trip Reports

“It’s not cold is it James. I don’t like our chances of any freeze up higher.” Between breaths, as we slogged up through bush on the Coral Track in the hour before dawn, James Hobson agreed. Soon we breached the bush line and encountered our first snow around 1,200 metres. And to our surprise, it was frozen. Alpenglow revealed a line of well-trodden steps stretching in to the distance up Rome Ridge. Weekend climbers had reported very soft, arduous snow, demanding too much time to get beyond Low Peak. But the weather had been settled now for four or more days and their still well formed steps provided us a staircase. The windless sky gradually brightened clear. Perfect!

Just over three years before, another climbing buddy Steve Henderson and I, had set off before dawn up Otira Valley, plugging our own energy sapping steps. By the time we’d reached the big boulder near the top of Otira River, under a crystal clear blue sky, we’d reluctantly realised that our efforts were futile and to venture any further would be inviting burial beneath an avalanche. So now, as I climbed Rome Ridge, I said silent thankyou’s to the owners of the steps making it so much easier for us.

In such nice conditions Rome Ridge looked comfortably free-climb-able as we steadily ascended. On the steep, knife-edged sections though, I reflected on how much scarier and slower progress would be when iced up or in strong winds.

Our first little serving of gnarl came in a notch at 1,800 metres. A load of steps dropped left (south) off the ridge to avoid a steep narrow buttress. One set of steps carried on up along the edge of the buttress. “What do you reckon Pete – up or down?” “In these conditions up I reckon James. Is it ok on the far side of this thing?” James had climbed Rome Ridge as far as Low Peak the previous year. “Yeah, no problem from memory. Want to rope up or anything?” “Nah, I think it looks okay.” I led up. In hindsight James’ suggestion to rope up was the right one. There was just a small vertical rocky section where the snow and ice were thin that justified it, but those few steps were very exposed. I tentatively climbed up okay but, in so doing, disturbed the already tenuous snow. And the rope was in James’ pack. “Err... Hmmm ... my axe just went right through there... Hmmm...” I held my breath while James picked his way up to join me.

“Whew, at least the ground ahead should be fine... or not!” As we levelled out on top of the buttress the crux notch of Rome Ridge came into view. And between us and it was a void. Buggar. Until this point our progress had been swift, but now it looked like things were going to get technical. That single set of tantalising steps did still carry on down steep snow on the Bealey Valley side though, disappearing on the convex slope. I tentatively followed to see if there was a way down to the notch.

Right - On Rome Ridge at about 1,850m, just above and east of the notch

Below - At about 1,800m, on the narrow section before the notch



A fortunate alignment

A climb of Mount Rolleston via Rome Ridge
Words and pictures Peter Laurenson



Just as I confirmed that down climbing was going to be fine, James also located a fixed sling up above me. We didn't need it, but now we turned our attention to the next section, climbing out of the notch towards Low Peak – the crux. Steps again led both ways – left and right. “Which way James?” “Last time we definitely went right.” And off he went. As we struggled up through some exposed downward sloping, snow splattered rock, then a precarious little ice cheval, the advice the Arthurs Pass Oracle Graeme Kates had given me the evening before came flooding back. “My mate mentioned an unpleasant patchy rock and snow section just on the Bealey side of the ridge. Sounds like that is best to avoid if you can.” “Yes, I see what you mean now Graeme” I thought to myself as we carefully plugged up a steep, exposed snow face back on to the crest of the ridge – where, at 1,950 metres all the other steps reappeared.

From there the going was straight forward and we arrived at 2,212 metres on top of Low Peak about 11am, six hours after having set off. “Well, it took us a bit longer than I'd first thought, but at least we can claim a pretty unbroken ascent of Rome Ridge James.” A cold breeze now blew but the weather remained clear, affording 360 degree panoramas that could not fail to pump joy into the heart of any photographer. I was certainly having a good time and our view northwest to the main summit looked eminently doable. But first, time for a spot of lunch.

The route on to the summit dropped off low Peak to the upper edge of Crow Glacier, skirting beneath a steep rocky buttress, before climbing again into another notch. Climbing out of the notch gave us another small helping of gnarl, very similar to the first in terms of thin snow and ice on a small steep section of rock. We managed to free climb it but I was definitely not keen on down climbing it. In fact, the cumulative effect of quite a lot of exposure during the morning encouraged me to suggest we pitch from there on.

James put in three not totally bullet-proof cams but, as the final section below the summit came into view from behind the rocky outcrop where he stood, we could see that a fall was going to be unlikely. The rope still had a calming influence though as I climbed through and set up a T slot just below the summit for James to follow up on.

“It's still sinking in that I'm actually on top James. I've been looking at this peak for three years. Life is good!” The summit of Mount Rolleston is just the 2,275 metre high point on a long narrow ridge. There wasn't a huge amount of room up there and the wind was up so, after I'd covered, to my satisfaction, all angles photographically, I carefully followed James back to our packs back at my T slot point. An easy pitch and a reassuring 30 metre abseil later saw us back down in the notch, comfortable in the knowledge that the rest of our day should be quite straight forward.



Above - Crotch-eye view on Rome Ridge at about 2,000m

Below - On Low Peak (2,212m), with the main summit (2,275m) left skyline



Our round trip from Low Peak to the summit and back had taken about two and half hours, so we set off on our descent to Goldney Ridge about 2pm. The going was steep, mostly facing in to the slope, but straight forward. By now any freeze had well and truly become a distant memory in the bright sunlight. Any thought of climbing it made me wince, but the snow was actually quite pleasant for descending – soft but predictable. Looking below at the Otira Valley I could see one or two avalanche sites, but generally everything appeared pretty stable – in line with the “moderate” rating given by avalanche.net.nz.

Although steps led off along Goldney Ridge, we decided to drop off down the Slide almost immediately after reaching the ridge. Being wary of afternoon avalanche danger, we kept close to the edge of the snow slope until it broadened out and the gradient relented at about 1,600 metres. “This takes me back three years James” I remarked as we crashed thigh deep into soft wet snow. While there was still some gradient to work with the best way forward was on our bums. Thankfully the snow improved a bit once we reached the shade of the Philistine Ridge and then it ran out altogether at about 1,200 metres.

James is less than half my age and mountain fit by any climber’s standards. While I plodded, nursing my ailing knee joints, he disappeared at speed. The gesture was both kindly and logical – his Ute was parked back at the base of the Coral Track three kms down Highway 73 from the Otira Valley carpark. He figured he’d save me having to cover that ground and also save himself from having to wait for me. Smart!

I trudged into the carpark at the end of Otira Valley at 5.30pm, twelve and half hours after we started. James was already back, airing his feet in a reclining position. He’d run the 3kms in his climbing boots, claiming that having enjoyed a summit day, he’d felt extra perky. We had certainly enjoyed a fortunate alignment of conditions for our climb, the only disappointment that wonderful day being that the Pub at Arthurs Pass Village is closed on Tuesdays.



Above - On the descent at about 1,950m, with Goldney Ridge below centre

Below - From the summit, with Otira Valley left, Crow Glacier on the right and Low Peak right of centre



For more captioned images and a route map

www.occasionalclimber.co.nz

North Island Ski Touring Meet

5 to 7 October 2018, based at Tukino Lodge

40 NZAC members from throughout the North Island attended the ski touring meet at Tukino in early October. Alongside the meet an avalanche course was held. Wellington was well represented with 4 carloads heading north. Saturday was a cracker day - mainly sunny and calm. Many a kilometer was toured with happy faces at day end. Litres of water downed before moving on to celebratory drinks.



Greg and Kate made the best effort when it came to fancy dress among the section. The Auckland Red Hot Chilli Peppers certainly stood out. Sunday delivered rain showers and wind. A few hardy souls stayed out to mid afternoon, while most of us were back early for a cuppa and warm up. Thanks to Mac for organising a great meet. Also to our Jenny and Eric for contributing to the organisation. Words Keith Munro

Above and below, photos Barnaby Arnott



Above and below, photos Bernd Pummer



Section Contacts

Powered by volunteers

We're always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. A lot goes on to keep our club going, virtually all powered by volunteers. On the back page is our "Club on a page" summary. It gives an at a glance description of all the things we do, how and why. Feel free to print a copy and pass it on to anyone who might be interested in becoming a member or volunteer. And if you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Role	Name	Contact
Chair person	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Secretary, gear custodian	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Treasurer	Vacant	
Trip co-ordinator	Eric Duggan	021 350 161
Section nights, Vertigo, Photocomp	Peter Laurenson	021 446 725
Social media	Marie Kelly	
Club liaison	Keith Munro	
Library, Projects	Alex Waterworth	
General Committee	Matt Pemberton	
General Committee	Guy Dubuis	
General Committee	Joshua Mouat	
Patron	John Nankervis	
Rock drill overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 555 5893



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New routes every week*

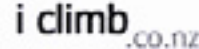
\$1000 worth of new holds in Jan/Feb 2012
New pad in "Da Cave" allowing safe aggressive bouldering

Creating happiness through better climbing

* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.



HangDog Rock Climbing Adventures
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Lower Hutt
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info@hangdog.co.nz
www.hangdog.co.nz



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\$230

Makalu
\$255

Caiman
\$230



i climb .co.nz

For quick access to our Section's page on the NZAC website, click or scan this QR code



WHAT WE DO

FOR MEMBERS

Facilities

- * Huts
- * Gear
- * Library
- * Discounts

Training

- * Level 1- 3 winter skills
- * Summer rock
- * Instructors

Climbing trips

- * Section
- * National
- * International

FOR MEMBERS AND WIDER PUBLIC

Publications

- * Website
- * Social media
- * Vertigo
- * Guide books

Events

- * Banff mountain film festival
- * Reel Rock
- * Photo comp

Networking

- * Section nights
- * Conferences and meetings
- * Lobbying

HOW WE DO IT

Organise, encourage, support, enable

Inform, entertain, promote

OUR RESOURCES

Volunteer time and capabilities, income from events and gear hire, national office support, sponsorship

WHY WE DO IT

Connecting & developing more climbing & mountaineering people, knowledge, skills & experience, thereby ...

... building lifelong friendships

... protecting and improving access to alpine places

... sustaining and growing climbing and mountaineering achievement

... enhancing alpine safety

... building appreciation, enjoyment and protection of alpine places

Annual Reports

Annual accounts 2017/18 FY

[Click here](#)

Section nights 2017/18 FY

In the past 12 months section nights have been held, usually on the last Wednesday each month, at the Tuatara Brewery The Third Eye from 6pm. No section nights were held in December or January due to the Christmas break.

A range of speakers presented trips and other subjects related to climbing including risk management, climbing accidents, outdoor photography and club matters. Section nights also featured the annual photo competition judging and the AGM.

Turnouts vary from between about 20 and 50.

Section nights have continued to run in July to November 2018 and are booked from February to May 2019 at time of reporting. The table below lists each section night during the reporting period.

Section night	Subject	Speaker
Wed 26th Jul 2017	The Aussie eight	Nigel Roberts
Wed 30th Aug	Wellington Section photo competition judging night	Peter Laurenson
Wed 27th Sep	Outdoor photography presentation	Peter Laurenson
Wed 25th Oct	Incoming club President, plus AGM (?)	John Palmer
Wed 29th Nov	Observations of a climbing accident survivor	Dave Eaton
Dec 2017	No section night	NA
Jan 2018	No section night	NA
Wed 28th Feb	Hangdog and pizza gathering	NA
Wed 28th Mar	An attempt of Acongagua, South America	John Phillips
Wed 25th Apr	Risk management	Rohan Light
Wed 30th May	The Cave book	Marcus Thomas
Wed 27th June	Climbing new routes in the Khumbu, Nepal	Steve Fortune

Annual photo competition August 2017

Peter Laurenson judged the entries for the annual Wellington Section photo competition and presented their findings at the August section night. Once again the standard of entries varied, but some excellent entries were received, some of which went on to do well at the national competition.

The number of entries was comparable to last year. The table below compares 2017 to last year across the seven categories. Only 20 or so turned up for the section night, but those that did attend found it useful.

NZAC Wellington entries	2015	2016	2017	Change
Alpine General	28	28	28	0%
Alpine Activity	13	19	18	-5%
Alpine Nature	12	19	22	16%
Rock climbing	11	8	7	-13%
Mountain Culture	5	11	21	91%
Humour	4	12	6	-50%
Kids	13	11	5	-55%

ReelRock 12 Film Festival 14, 21 November 2017

For the second time we hosted the Reel Rock movie event. In 2016 the venue was the Paramount, but due to this venue becoming unavailable, in 2017 we shifted to Nga Taonga Sound & Vision, which has a capacity limitation of 107 seats. Pricing was held the same as in 2016 – members/students \$19, non-members \$21, children \$14. Our two sell out screenings ran on Tuesday 14th and 21st November. Bookings were handled by us independently of the venue, using the online engine Eventopia, which worked very well.

The event was a modest financial success (inclusive gst) as follows.

	2017	2016
Reel Rock movie hire (USD1,250)	1,847.75	1,447.78
Venue hire	1,380.00	1,150.00
Incidentals (poster printing, etc)	47.56	50.00
Total costs	3,275.31	2,647.78
Eventopia revenue	4,237.00	3,486.00
Surplus	961.69	838.22

Banff Mountain Film Festival 7, 10, 11 ,14 June 2018

As we have for many years now, Wellington Section ran screenings of movies from the BANFF Film Festival earlier this year. With the demise of the Paramount Theatre we scoured Wellington looking for an alternate venue. We settled on the Memorial Theatre up at Victoria University and showed two screenings of two different programmes of films. All four screenings were a sellout, showing us that the BANFF movies remain a popular outing for folk around Wellington. This event is a major fundraiser both for the section and for National Office.

It should be noted that we have little influence over the selection of films included in the programmes. In previous years we were able to pick and choose films from a relatively long list but the BANFF Film Festival organisers now provide a few programme options that they put together so we have little influence over which films are screened. We’d love more mountaineering films but it seems that either there are very few being made and screened at BANFF or they’re not being included in the programmes provided to us.

The survey ran by National Office after the event provided valuable feedback which we will take on board in planning the event in 2019. The survey results showed us that 77% of those surveyed would recommend the event to friends and 74% rated the event to be excellent or good value. That’s the good news. The bad news is that those surveyed definitely didn’t rate the venue - loads of comments were made about ncomfortable seats, no drinks or food available, too loud, too cold, too far out of town. With such resounding negative feedback we’ve started the search for an alternative venue in town for 2019.

Ski Film Night 17 September 2018

A ski film night was held in mid September at Victoria University, showing a Teton Gravity Research (TGR) double feature. Turn out was very disappointing and the night ran at a loss. It has been difficult to determine why the evening wasn’t better supported. Feedback includes: it was a specialist evening rather than covering various outdoor activities, the venue is not popular, it was held at the wrong time of the year, TGR is not as well known as Warren Miller. If we repeat the evening, consideration will be given to showing a single film only, using a smaller theatre and having the night prior to the ski season.

Gross Revenue	\$791.00
less	
Venue Cost	\$1,483.50
TGR films	\$666.53
Net profit/loss	-\$1,359.03